Teaching the Truth

Because nothing but the cross of Christ produces the new creation, the grace gospel must be presented persuasively, precisely, plainly, positively and personally — without adding to it or subtracting from it.

Where this study fits

Galatians · sixteen studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5 The Ground of Liberty	**02** 1:6–10 The One True Gospel	**03** 1:11–17 Paul's Independent Revelation	**04** 1:18–2:10 Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches
05 2:11–21 Peter Goes Back to School	**06** 3:1–5 Under a Spell	**07** 3:6–14 Blessing or a Curse	**08** 3:15–29 The Superiority of the Promise to the Law
09 4:1–11 When I Became a Man	**10** 4:12–20 A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove	**11** 4:21–31 Paul's Old Testament Story	**12** 5:1–12 Taking a Stand in Liberty
13 5:13–26 Walk in the Spirit	**14** 6:1–5 Brothers and Burdens	**15** 6:6–10 Sowing and Reaping	**16** 6:11–18 Teaching the Truth

Five ways to present the truth

Galatians 6:11–18 · The commentary's outline

Persuasively	Precisely	Plainly	Positively	Personally
Large letters, in his own hand	Exposing motives; boasting only in the cross	Walk by this rule — peace and mercy	The marks of the Lord Jesus	Grace with your spirit, brethren
v.11	*vv.12–15*	*v.16*	*v.17*	*v.18*

Say what needs to be said, the way it needs to be said — without adding to the gospel or subtracting from it.

Unseen motives and upper motives

Galatians 6:12–15 · Outline II — Present the truth precisely

Their unseen motives — vv.12–13

1. Approval of people
εὐπροσωπῆσαι a good showing in the flesh

2. Avoidance of persecution
διώκωνται for the cross of Christ

3. Appearance of perfection
they don't keep the law themselves

4. Attitude of pride
καυχήσωνται boasting in your flesh

Paul's upper motives — vv.14–15

1. The cross — v.14
“God forbid that I should boast except in the cross”
ἐσταύρωται Perf. — the world crucified to me, and I to the world

2. Christ — v.15
Neither circumcision nor uncircumcision avails anything
καινὴ κτίσις a new creation — new in kind

Large letters and lasting marks

Galatians 6:11, 17 · Outline I and IV — Persuasively and positively

Persuasively — v.11
πηλίκοις γράμμασιν with how large letters

- Paul took the pen from his secretary
- A visible, forceful final emphasis
- Truth presented with weight, not indifference

Positively — v.17
στίγματα brand-marks of ownership

- Not mystical “stigmata”
- Real scars from stoning and beatings
- Proof of his dedication — let no one trouble me

You think I'm not dedicated? These marks say otherwise — I belong to the Lord Jesus.

Peace and mercy — on whom?

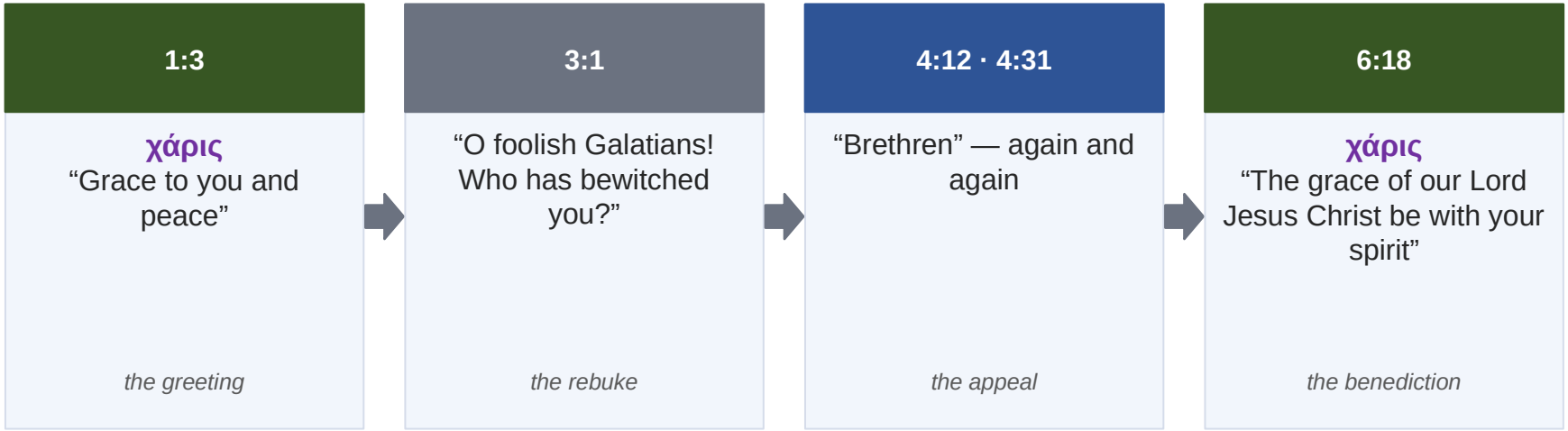
Galatians 6:16 · Outline III — Present the truth plainly

v.16a	“As many as walk according to this rule” — grace, plus not one thing	**κανόνι** a measuring rod — “canon”
v.16b	“peace and mercy be upon them” — the curse of 1:8–9 replaced by peace	accepted on what Christ has done
v.16c	“and upon the Israel of God” — believing Jews among them	not the church renamed Israel

We are accepted by God never more, and never less, than the moment we first believed.

Grace first, grace last

Galatians 1:3 and 6:18 · Outline V — Present the truth personally



Paul's last word to the Galatians is his first word to them, said one more time: grace.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 6:11–18 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What modern equivalents of the Judaizers' motives — approval, avoiding conflict, appearing put-together, pride in numbers — show up in ministry today?

2. What does it look like practically to boast in nothing except the cross of Christ?

Apply

Check Your Own Unseen Motives

Name one motive honestly before God this week and ask Him to replace it with a desire to boast only in the cross.

Live as the New Creation You Are

Write down one way your new-creation identity in Christ should change a decision you're facing.

In one line: Grace first and grace last: boast only in the cross, and teach the truth without adding or subtracting.